
WHAT YOU VALUE MOST

Where your dental money actually goes

How dental costs are structured, six ways to spend less without gambling, and an honest note about when a bigger clinic is the better answer.

The Practical · A Dentist Fit guide · General information, not dental advice

Why this is a reasonable thing to want

Cost is a legitimate way to choose dental care and it is treated as slightly shameful, which helps nobody. Most people are working with a fixed annual insurance maximum and a real budget, and the sensible question is not how to spend more but where spending actually buys something.

The structure is worth knowing. Prevention is the cheapest dentistry that exists, by a wide margin, because it is the only category that stops other categories from happening. After that, cost tracks how much tooth has been lost, which is why the same problem gets more expensive the longer it is left.

This is not an argument for any particular practice, including this one. It is an argument for looking at the decade rather than the invoice, which sometimes points at the cheaper option and sometimes does not.

Six ways to spend less without gambling

These work on any practice. Take them with you wherever you go, including somewhere that is not us.

1 Do not skip the recall appointment

It is the cheapest appointment you will have and the only one whose whole purpose is preventing the expensive ones. Skipping it to save money is the single most reliable way to spend more.

2 Know your insurance properly

The annual maximum, what resets in January, and what percentage each category is covered at. Large work split across two calendar years can use two annual maximums.

3 Check the Canadian Dental Care Plan

Eligibility has been expanding, and plenty of people who qualify have not checked. Reflections accepts it. Worth five minutes on the federal site.

4 Ask what the options are at different prices

Many treatments have more than one material or approach with different costs and different lifespans. Ask for the range and how long each is expected to last.

5 Deal with small things while they are small

The gap between a filling and what a neglected filling becomes is large, and it is the main way dental care gets genuinely expensive.

Ask about payment arrangements before ruling something out

Practices vary and many will stage work over time or arrange payments. It is a normal conversation and it is worth having before deciding you cannot proceed.

The honest note. If price and convenience are your top two priorities, a larger clinic with extended hours and volume pricing may be exactly the right answer for you, and we would rather say so plainly. We are two chairs, appointments run longer, and we are not the cheapest option in Calgary. That is worth weighing rather than being talked out of.

Signs you are getting value, wherever you go

- You understand every line on your bill
- Nothing was added to the work without being explained first
- You know when you are expected back and why
- Preventive appointments are treated as important rather than as a formality
- Nobody made you feel awkward for asking what something costs

WHERE WE FIT

A small practice, on purpose

Reflections is two chairs on Crowchild Trail. Dr. Ashish Mehta sees a small number of people, and that is a deliberate choice about how he wants to practise.

Longer appointments cost more to provide, so this is not the cheapest practice in the city and it does not claim to be. What the time buys is explanation and thoroughness, which is worth different amounts to different people.

"I see a small number of people, and that is on purpose."

Dr. Ashish Mehta

Ask us these too

This guide is only worth anything if it works on us as well. If you come in, put these to Dr. Mehta directly.

1 What does a checkup and cleaning cost here?

Ask before you book anything. A straightforward answer is a good sign in itself.

2 Do you follow the Alberta fee guide?

A fair and common question, and one that practices are used to answering.

3 What would you prioritise if I could only do one thing this year?

The most useful question on a budget, and it tells you a great deal about how someone thinks.

Fifteen minutes, free, no treatment

If you want to look before deciding, the fifteen minutes is free and involves no treatment and no cost. Some people come, decide we are not their fit, and leave with a better set of questions for wherever they go instead. That is a perfectly good outcome.

Book your free 15 minutes

4600 Crowchild Trail NW, Suite 505, Calgary · (587) 327-8651

Nothing is done to your teeth at this visit, and there is no cost.

This guide is general information about choosing dental care. It is not dental advice, it is not a diagnosis, and it is not a comment on any other practice. The questions in it are worth asking of any dentist, including this one. Your own dentist knows your mouth and your history, and nothing here replaces that. Reflections Dental Group, Calgary, Alberta.